

How to Build an OpenClaw Agent



OpenClaw

THE AI THAT ACTUALLY DOES THINGS.

Clears your inbox, sends emails, manages your calendar, checks you in for flights.

All from WhatsApp, Telegram, or any chat app you already use.



What is OpenClaw?

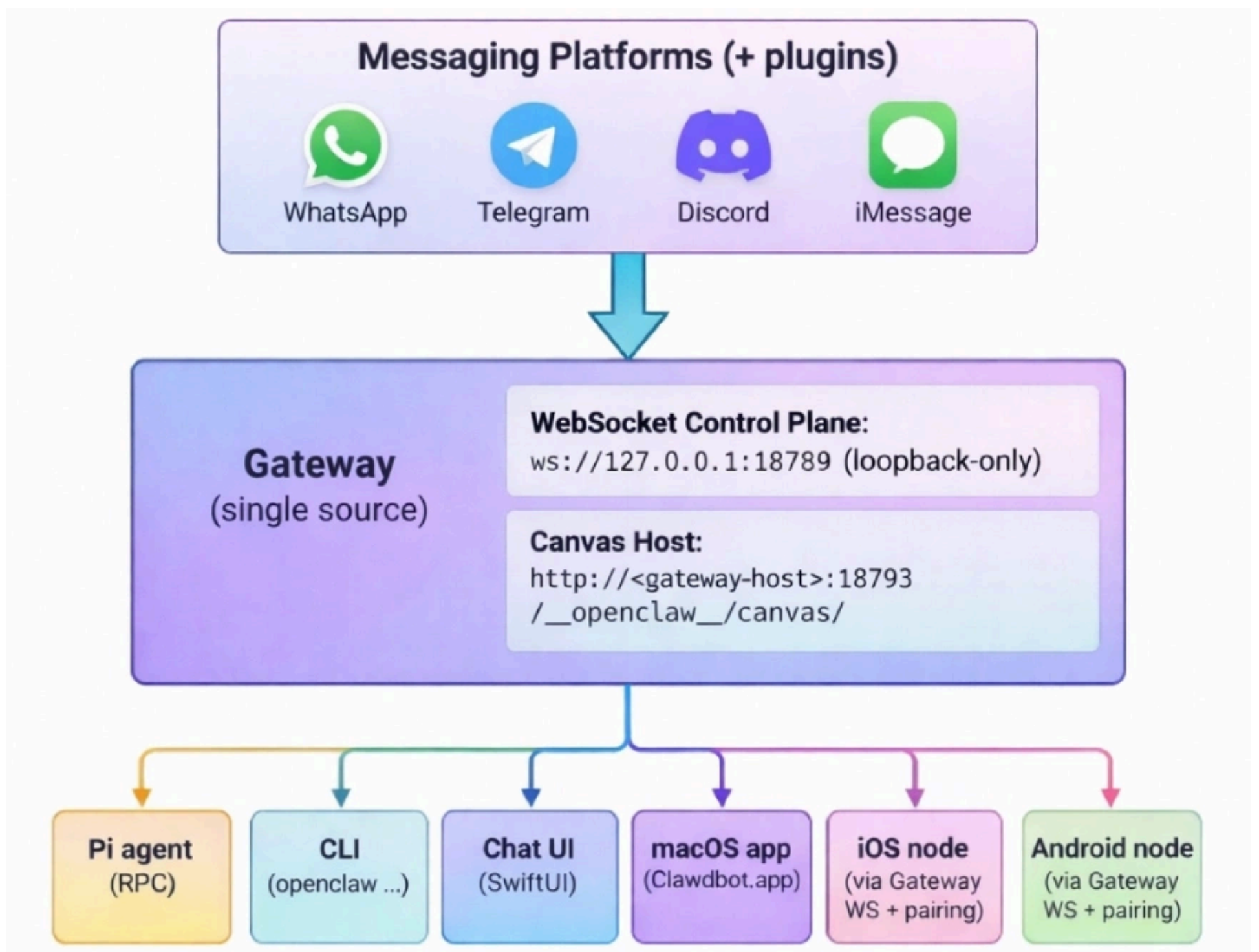
Originally Clawdbot, then Moltbot, and now OpenClaw this open-source AI assistant runs locally as a persistent personal agent.

It integrates AI agents, automation tools, and messaging interfaces, giving developers full control over data, execution, and model selection without relying on centralised cloud platforms.

- ➡ Local & Private Your data never leaves your machine.
- ➡ Autonomous Acts without constant hand-holding.
- ➡ Any Messenger WhatsApp, Telegram, Discord, iMessage.

Architecture of OpenClaw

- **Messaging Gateway:** Interfaces communication and authentication across platforms.
- **Agent Core:** Interprets intent, plans actions, remembers past events, and drives execution.
- **Memory System:** Maintains structured, persistent memory as sequences and vectors.
- **Execution Layer:** Interfaces with the OS to perform tasks.



Getting Started with OpenClaw

The prerequisites for running OpenClaw:

- Node.js (v22+)
- Terminal access
- API key for an LLM provider
- Messaging platform account

You can install OpenClaw by using the following command:

```
npm install -g openclaw@latest
```

For the initial setup of your environment, use the below command:

```
openclaw onboard --install-daemon
```

This command guides you through configuring the model provider, workspace, Gateway service, and messaging integrations. Review the setup options and enable only what's needed.

OpenClaw in Action

Beyond answering questions, OpenClaw can send results to WhatsApp, store them, or trigger follow-up tasks making it an autonomous assistant, not just conversational AI

Example Prompt:

"Every morning, provide me with a summary of the latest AI research news."

What OpenClaw does:

1. Schedules the task as a recurring morning routine
2. Searches and aggregates the latest AI research
3. Formats a structured summary
4. Delivers it directly to your WhatsApp

When you ask a question on WhatsApp, the agent processes it locally, breaks it into steps, and generates a structured response analysing information, running commands, and sending detailed outputs back.

OpenClaw: Deploying Autonomous AI Assistants Safely and at Scale

As enterprises transition from reactive LLMs to proactive agentic workflows, securing the execution environment remains a critical architectural challenge.

This session explores how OpenClaw provides the essential sandboxing, policy guardrails, and governance infrastructure required to deploy autonomous AI assistants safely and at scale.

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